

number) and the officer is satisfied as to the bona fides of the goods, a certified copy of a Form PO2 should be given to the exporter and a duplicate kept at the office. The exporter should be informed to obtain a certificate of postage from An Post. An alternative document to Form PO2, e.g., a suitably adapted customs declaration, may be used provided it contains all the necessary information.

Unfortunately, when there are no clearly identifying marks on the goods, Revenue has no easy method to satisfy itself as to the bona fides of the case and certify exportation of the goods. The exporter must produce the goods together with a Form PO2 and certificate of postage at a Revenue office. After examination of the goods, having compared them with the details given on certificate of postage, and on being satisfied as to their bona fides, the officer should seal the parcel and hand it back to the exporter together with the certificate of postage, noted accordingly, for production to An Post.

On return of the copy of the certificate of postage certifying the postage of the goods, the certified original copy of the Form PO2 is to be given to the exporter for production on re-importation of the goods. The duplicate Form PO2 is to be filed.

Parcels handed over directly to An Post by an officer need not be sealed. In the case of goods which are easily identifiable by a serial number, the officer may directly certify export of the goods.

8.4 Prohibition and Restrictions

Goods which are prohibited or restricted on exportation are listed under [Prohibitions and Restrictions](#) and staff at the postal depots should make An Post aware of the contents of this list from time to time. An Post also set restrictions on what type of goods can be sent by post. This list is available on [An Post website](#).

8.5 Authorised Postal Operators

8.5.1 General

Under existing legislation, An Post is designated as a universal service provider (USP) with the obligation to provide a full range of postal services. However, arising from recent EU Directives the postal market is open to full competition since 1 January 2011.

8.5.2 Regulation of postal service operators

Anyone can set up a postal business to handle any form of mail provided that they have a postal service authorisation from the Commission for Communication Regulation (ComReg). These postal service operators must also:

- (i) draw up a code of practice covering customer complaints and redress; and
- (ii) make sure that they meet essential requirements in relation to the postal services they provide, for example, security of mail, protection from loss or damage and so on.